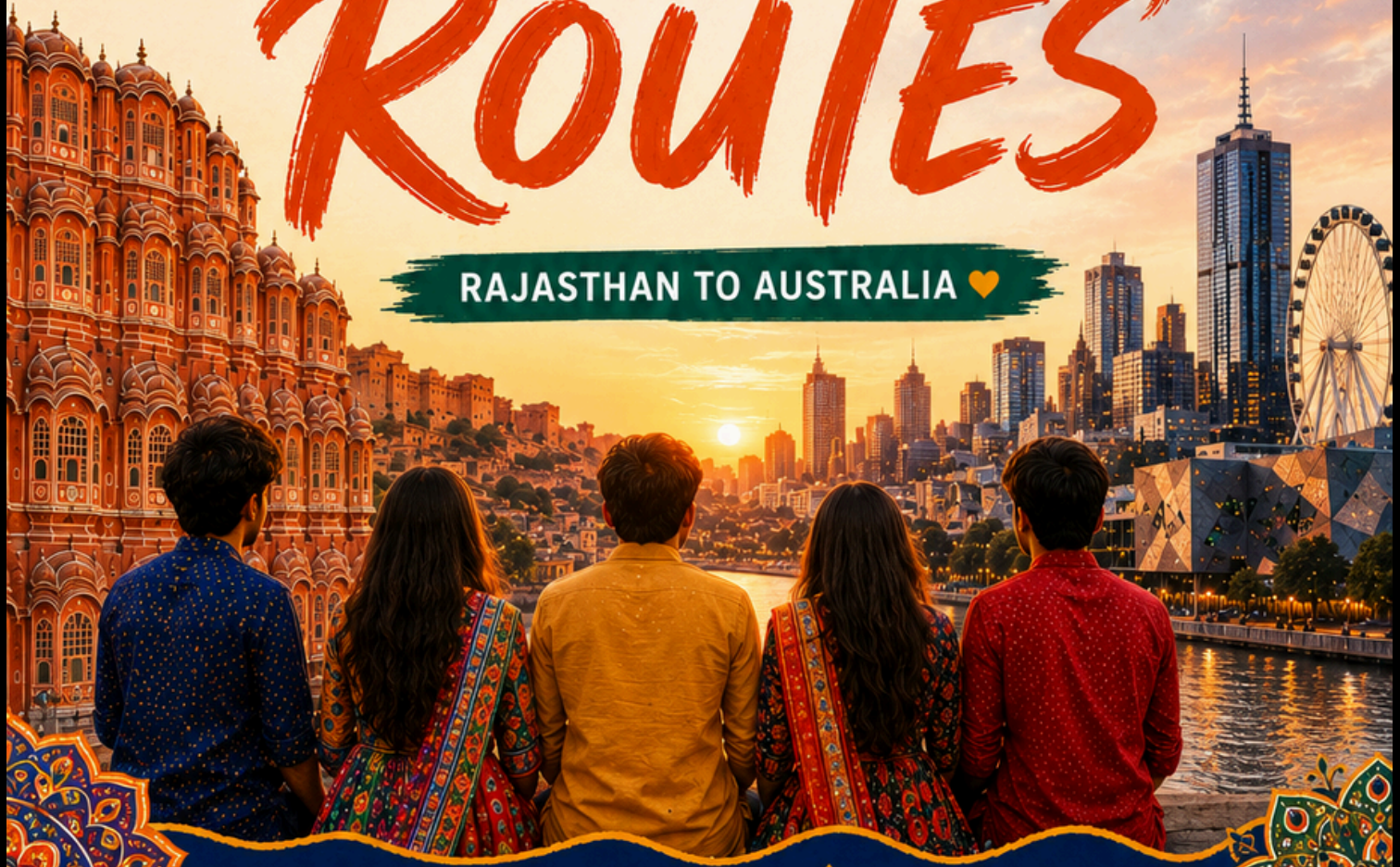
YOUTH & COMMUNITY NEWSLETTER

2026–27

RAJKOV ROOTS & ROUTES

RAJASTHAN TO AUSTRALIA ♥



OUR HERITAGE | OUR COMMUNITY | OUR FUTURE | OUR PRIDE

2026–27 Edition

Celebrating Rajasthan • Growing Together in Australia

ROOTS & ROUTES

What does being Rajasthani mean when you've grown up in Australia?

Stories • Culture • Festivals • Music • Careers • Community

A celebration of Rajasthani heritage, identity, and community life across Australia. From vibrant festivals to career journeys, this is your space.

RAJKOV Youth & Community Newsletter

Join us as we explore what it means to carry Rajasthan in our hearts while building our futures on Australian soil.

Connecting young Rajasthani Australians through culture, creativity, and community spirit across generations.

Issue #1

President’s Message

खम्मा घणी सा, राम राम सा, म्हारा राजकोव रतन कुटुम्ब! 🙏
It is my honour and privilege to welcome you all to another memorable gathering of our Rajkov Ratan Kutumb.
Before we begin, I respectfully acknowledge the Traditional Custodians of this land, pay my respects to their Elders—past, present and emerging—and thank Australia for giving us the opportunity to live, grow and celebrate our heritage.

I offer my heartfelt gratitude to our Founder Members, whose vision and dedication transformed a dream into the vibrant Rajkov family we proudly cherish today. थां बिना आज रो राजकोव संभव कोनी होतो।

My sincere thanks also go to our Past Presidents, Committee Members and Volunteers, whose selfless service has built the strong foundation we stand on today.
It is my privilege to introduce our Executive Committee, committed to serving with integrity, transparency and unity, alongside our energetic Youth Committee, whose passion and fresh ideas will carry Rajkov’s culture, values and traditions proudly into the future.

Over the coming year, we will strengthen our community through meaningful cultural celebrations, youth leadership, newcomer support, community service, and the preservation of our proud Rajasthani heritage while embracing Australia’s multicultural values.

As we say, ”राजकोव कोई संस्था मात्र कोनी... ई तो म्हारो कुटुम्ब है।” Rajkov is not just an organisation —it is our family. To our members, thank you for your trust and support. To those joining us today, थां सब रो दिल सूं हार्दिक स्वागत है।

Together, let us inspire, support and uplift one another—एकजुट रहां, साथ चलां, अर समाज री सेवा ने आगे बढ़ावां। With your participation, Rajkov’s future is brighter than ever.
पधारो सा... आप सब रो राजकोव रतन कुटुम्ब में हार्दिक स्वागत है।

Thank you for being part of this incredible journey.
पधारो सा... आप सब रो राजकोव रतन कुटुम्ब में हार्दिक स्वागत है।
आपरी सेवा में,
Vishal Gupta- President- Rajkov Ratan Kutumb

About RAJKOV

More Than a community. More Than Festivals.
RAJKOV (Rajasthani Kutumb of Victoria) is where culture, family and belonging come together.

We unite Rajasthani families to celebrate our traditions, build lifelong friendships and inspire the next generation of leaders. Whether your roots are in Rajasthan or Australia, RAJKOV welcomes everyone with the warmth of family.

From vibrant cultural festivals and family gatherings to youth leadership, community service and professional networking, we create opportunities to connect, grow and give back. Proud of our heritage and inspired by Australia's multicultural spirit, we are preserving our traditions while building a stronger future together.
Our roots unite us. Our values inspire us. Our future belongs to all of us.

A Message from Our Founding Families

In 2003, far from our homeland but united by our shared Rajasthani roots, six families came together with a simple dream—to create a home away from home for Rajasthanis in Victoria.

What began as informal gatherings to celebrate our festivals, speak our language, and support one another soon grew into RAJKOV – Rajasthani Kutumb of Victoria. The vision was never just to organise events, but to build a family where every Rajasthani would feel welcomed, connected, and proud of their heritage while embracing life in Australia.

We gratefully acknowledge our founding families, whose vision laid the foundation for the vibrant community we enjoy today:

- Ghanshyam & Savita Soni
- Brij & Vandana Panwar
- Mahendra & Sunita Goyal
- Rajesh & Sunita Manihar
- Rajiv & Anjul Sharma
- The Jawle Family, who contributed during the early days before relocating to the United States.

Today, more than two decades later, RAJKOV continues to grow because of their foresight, commitment and belief that our culture, traditions and values are strongest when shared as one family. We honour their legacy and remain committed to carrying that vision forward for generations to come.

Founder’s Stories

Brij Panwar co-founded RAJKOV in 2003 with five other families to preserve Rajasthani culture, connect future generations to their roots, and build a supportive community in Australia. As RAJKOV’s first Secretary, and later Vice President and President, he laid the foundation for the organisation’s growth. His home remains RAJKOV’s registered address, and his continued mentorship, guidance and service as Returning Officer have helped shape the inclusive and vibrant community RAJKOV is today.

Founder’s Stories

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Mahendra Ji dedicated nearly 26 years as an Accounting Lecturer at Monash University, while Sunita Ji has been the pillar of their family. Together, they have remained committed to fostering a strong, connected Rajasthani community where festivals, traditions and values continue to thrive. Their dedication has helped shape RAJKOV into the vibrant and welcoming family it is today

Committee Corner

Vishal Gupta

Role : President
Fav festival: Diwali, Holi 💛
Fun fact : I portrayed king Ashok role in class 12th

Rahuk Jain

Role : Vice President
Fav festival: Gangaur💛
Fun fact : I love meeting friends

Ritu Singh

Role : Treasurer
Fav festival: Teej 💛
Fun fact : I was selected in SSB army cadet but didnt proceed

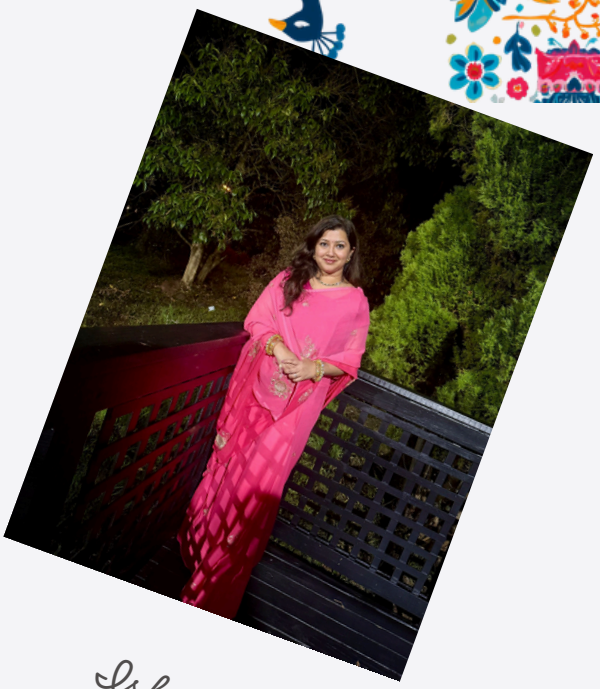
Bhoomija

Role : Committee Member
Fav festival: Teej 💛
Fun fact : I started roller skating when I was 4

Committee Corner

Akshat Soni

Role : Scretary
Fav festival: Diwali, Holi
Fact Files: If nothing else, you'd find me solving the rubiks cube.



Ishita Singh

Role : Committee Member
Fav festival: Diwali, Holi💛

Commitee Initiatives

Hello Everyone,

This year, the RAJKOV Committee has taken a proactive approach to strengthen our community by launching the Youth Committee and RAJKOV Youth Band to empower the next generation. We introduced a pre-planned annual calendar with early venue bookings, making it easier for families to plan and ensuring well-organised events. Membership has been enhanced with Unique Annual & Life Member Family IDs and an Early Bird RAJKOV Coin initiative to encourage timely renewals. We have also started early engagement with sponsors and are actively pursuing government grants and council funding opportunities to support community programs and ensure the long-term sustainability of RAJKOV. Together, these initiatives are helping build a stronger, more connected, and future-ready community.

Youth Committee Corner

Bhoomija

Role : Committee Member

Fav festival: Teej 💛

Fun fact : I started roller skating when I was 4

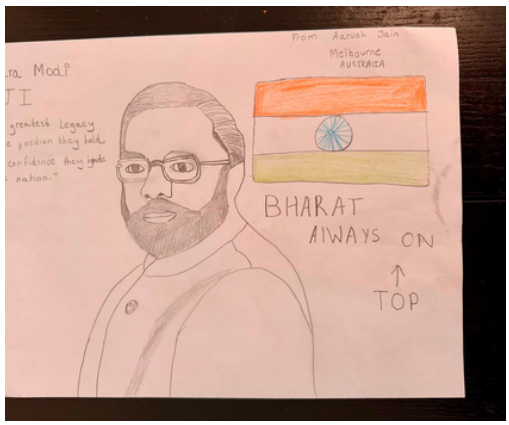
- Aarna Tripathi
- Arjun Agarwal
- Aryan Sharma
- Avantika Gupta
- Bani Sodha
- Ira Singh
- Ishi Kawar
- Kanakvi kawar
- Malika chaudhry
- Palasha Rana
- Prasiddhi Kothari
- Reeya Khanduri
- Saanvi Mantari
- Sanemi Jajoo
- Shaunik Sharma
- Soaham Chauhan
- Taanya dhariwal
- Varnika Koolwal
- Veer Chauhan

Youth Spotlight

Hello Future Leaders of RAJKOV! 👋
Whether you were born in Rajasthan, Melbourne, or anywhere else, your story is now part of the RAJKOV story.
Our parents and grandparents brought with them the colours, traditions and values of Rajasthan. Now it's our turn to keep that spirit alive—not just by celebrating festivals, but by creating new memories, building friendships and shaping what it means to be a proud Rajasthani in Australia.
You don't need to speak perfect Marwari or know every tradition to belong here. If you're curious, passionate and willing to connect, you're already part of the family.
This newsletter is your space. Share your achievements, ideas, stories, photos, talents and experiences. Whether it's sport, music, dance, business, volunteering or simply making a difference, we'd love to celebrate you.
Let's honour our roots, embrace our future, and build a community where every young Rajasthani feels proud to say:
"I'm part of RAJKOV."
See you at our next event!
Vishal Gupta
President, RAJKOV (Rajasthani Kutumb of Victoria)

Avantika Gupta

Aarush Jain



Ira Singh

Community Corner & Volunteer Opportunity

Hello Everyone,

I hope this message finds you well! I wanted to take a moment to discuss something that is very dear to me—our wonderful heritage and its significance for our future here in Australia. Our parents traveled all the way from Rajasthan, carrying with them a wealth of traditions and a vibrant culture. Now, it's our opportunity to carry that legacy forward and define what Rajasthani culture will look like for the next generation.

- It doesn't matter if you're fluent in Marwari or just know a few phrases.
- Whether you've visited Jaipur countless times or haven't had the chance yet—this community is for everyone.

Each of us contributes a unique piece to the puzzle, and that's what makes our community truly special. This newsletter is your platform to connect, share, and celebrate our rich heritage. Let's continue to build something wonderful together!

Event Highlights

🌿 Chaupal 2026 – Event Highlights
A Celebration of Culture, Community & Togetherness
RAJKOV's Chaupal 2026 brought our community together for an afternoon filled with warmth, friendship and Rajasthani hospitality. Families, friends and members from across Victoria gathered to reconnect, celebrate our traditions and strengthen the bonds that make RAJKOV truly special.

✨ Highlights of the Day

🤝 Community Connect
Members old and new came together, sharing stories, laughter and the spirit of one extended family.

🎤 President's Address
The new Executive Committee shared its vision for 2026–27, unveiling exciting initiatives including the Youth Committee, Youth Band, RAJKOV Newsletter, traditional Ghoomar, unique Lifetime Member IDs, enhanced member communication and a pre-planned annual event calendar.

👥 Committee Introduction
The 2026–27 Executive Committee was introduced, reaffirming its commitment to transparency, collaboration and community service.

🙏 Honouring Our Legacy
A heartfelt tribute was paid to our Founding Families, Past Presidents, Committee Members and Volunteers, recognising their invaluable contributions to RAJKOV's journey over the past two decades.

🏆 Sponsor Appreciation
We proudly acknowledged our generous sponsors whose continued support enables RAJKOV to grow and deliver memorable experiences for our community.

🎭 Culture & Entertainment
The afternoon featured engaging cultural performances, interactive activities and vibrant conversations, reflecting the rich traditions and values of Rajasthan.

🍛 Traditional Hospitality
No Chaupal is complete without delicious food! Members enjoyed authentic flavours while reconnecting with friends and welcoming new families into the RAJKOV community.

Rajasthan Heritage Spotlight

Pagadi -Ri- Laaz

Historically, there are over 80–100 documented styles of Rajasthani pagdis (safas). The exact number varies because every region, princely state, and community developed its own unique way of tying a turban. Some historians even identify more than 100 variations.

The Rajasthani Pagdi (Safa) was much more than traditional headwear. It served four important purposes:

- ☀️ Protection – Shielded the head from the harsh sun, heat, and desert dust.
- 👑 Identity – Indicated a person's region, community, profession, or social status.
- 🤝 Honour – Symbolised dignity, respect, and self-esteem; removing one's pagdi was considered a loss of honour.
- 🎉 Tradition – Different colours and styles were worn for weddings, festivals, royal ceremonies, and other special occasions.

Cultural Importance
In Rajasthan, there is a famous saying:
"पगड़ी की लाज रखना" — To protect someone's honour.
Even today, presenting or tying a Safa for a guest is considered one of the highest marks of respect. It represents the Rajasthani values of honour, hospitality, and pride, making it far more than just a piece of cloth.

Community calendar

RAJKOV
Rajasthani Kutumb of Victoria
SINCE 2003

2026-27 Aninual Calendar

Celebrating Our Heritage. Strengthening Our Community.

1 — 18TH JULY 2026

CHAUPAL & DARBAR
Community Gathering
100 – 120 PEOPLE

2 — 29TH AUGUST 2026

TEEJ MAHOTSAV
Major Cultural Festival
300 – 350 PEOPLE

3 — EARLY NOV 2026

DIWALI MAHOTSAV
Community Celebration
150 – 200 PEOPLE

4 — MID FEB 2027

CHAUPAL & DARBAR
Community Gathering
100 – 120 PEOPLE

5 — END MARCH 2027

GANGAUR MAHOTSAV
Major Cultural Festival
300 – 350 PEOPLE

EVENT CLASSIFICATION

MAJOR CULTURAL FESTIVALS
Teej Mahotsav • Gangaur Mahotsav

COMMUNITY EVENTS
Chaupal & Darbar • Diwali Mahotsav

Let's celebrate our roots, create memories and build a stronger community!

DATES ARE TENTATIVE
Subject to change.

ATTENDANCE IS APPROXIMATE
May vary depending on the event.

MORE DETAILS SOON!
Venues, timings & registrations will be communicated in advance.

Kutumb initiative

Sponsors and Community Partners

Rajasthani and Proud

🪬 AUSSIE BORN. ROYALLY RAISED. 🪬

"You don't have to choose between being Australian and being Rajasthani. You can proudly be both."